

Delhi Public School, Sector-4, Bokaro

Subject: English

Class: 8th

Time Allowed: 45 minutes

Maximum Marks: 50

All questions are compulsory unless stated otherwise.

Name: _____

Roll Number: _____

Class: 8th Section: _____

Section A

Multiple Choice Questions

Attempt all questions. Each question carries marks as indicated.

1. [easy] What was the approximate year of Shivaji's birth? [1 Marks]
2. [easy] Which of the following ruled in the north of India during Shivaji's birth? [1 Marks]
3. [medium] At what age did Shivaji become convinced that he was divinely appointed for Hindu freedom? [1 Marks]
4. [medium] Around what year did Shivaji begin to seize weaker Bijapur outposts? [1 Marks]
5. [hard] What was a key factor that won Shivaji much admiration according to the study material? [1 Marks]
6. [medium] Who led the 20,000-strong army sent by the sultan of Bijapur against Shivaji in 1659? [1 Marks]
7. [hard] How did Shivaji manage to defeat Afzal Khan's army? [1 Marks]
8. [easy] Which coastal town did Shivaji sack to provoke the Mughals further? [1 Marks]
9. [medium] Who did Aurangzeb send as his most prominent general against Shivaji after the sacking of Surat? [1 Marks]
10. [easy] On what date did Shivaji and his son escape from house arrest in Agra? [1 Marks]

Section B

True or False

Attempt all questions. Each question carries marks as indicated.

1. [easy] India was entirely under Hindu rule at the time of Shivaji's birth. [1 Marks]
2. [medium] Shivaji began his exploits by attacking powerful Mughal outposts. [1 Marks]
3. [easy] Shivaji sacked the city of Agra to provoke the Mughals. [1 Marks]
4. [medium] Shivaji and his son were placed under house arrest in Delhi. [1 Marks]
5. [hard] Shivaji used baskets filled with sweets as a ruse to escape from Agra. [1 Marks]

Section C

Long Answer Questions

Attempt all questions. Each question carries marks as indicated.

1. [medium] Describe the political and religious situation in India at the time of Shivaji's birth, and how it influenced his early conviction. [5 Marks]
2. [medium] Explain the circumstances leading to Shivaji's confrontation with Afzal Khan and the strategy Shivaji employed to defeat him. [5 Marks]
3. [hard] Discuss the events that escalated the conflict between Shivaji and the Mughal emperor Aurangzeb, including key actions taken by both sides. [5 Marks]
4. [easy] Detail Shivaji's famous escape from Agra, including the method and the significance of this event. [5 Marks]

Section D

Short Note Questions

Attempt all questions. Each question carries marks as indicated.

1. [medium] Write a short note on Shivaji's initial exploits and his motivation for challenging existing powers. [5 Marks]
2. [easy] Write a short note on why Shivaji is known as the 'father of Indian navy'. [5 Marks]

Section E

One Word Answer Questions

Attempt all questions. Each question carries marks as indicated.

1. [easy] Which empire ruled in the north of India during Shivaji's time? [1 Marks]
2. [medium] What was the primary motivation for Shivaji's fight against the ruling powers? [1 Marks]
3. [easy] In which city were Shivaji and his son placed under house arrest by Aurangzeb? [1 Marks]
4. [medium] By what means did Shivaji and his son escape from Agra? [1 Marks]
5. [hard] What title is Shivaji known by for his pioneering use of sea power? [1 Marks]

Answer Key

Section A - Multiple Choice Questions

1. 1630
2. The Mughals
3. 16
4. 1655

5. His daring, military skill, and sternness toward oppressors of Hindus.
6. Afzal Khan
7. He enticed them into difficult mountain terrain and killed Afzal Khan at a lured meeting.
8. Surat
9. Mirza Raja Jai Singh
10. August 17, 1666

Section B - True or False

1. False
2. False
3. False
4. False
5. True

Section C - Long Answer Questions

1. At the time of Shivaji's birth, around 1630, India was under Muslim rule. The Mughals ruled in the north, and the Muslim sultans of Bijapur and Golconda ruled in the south. These rulers governed by right of conquest, without acknowledging obligations to their subjects. Shivaji, whose ancestral estates were in the Deccan within the Bijapur sultans' realm, found the Muslim oppression and religious persecution of the Hindus intolerable. This situation led him, by the age of 16, to firmly believe that he was chosen by divine will to achieve Hindu freedom.
2. In 1659, the sultan of Bijapur became concerned by Shivaji's growing power and sent an army of 20,000 men under Afzal Khan to defeat him. Shivaji, realizing the strength of this force, adopted a cunning strategy. He pretended to be intimidated and expressed submissive appeals, thereby luring Afzal Khan deep into difficult mountain terrain. At a pre-arranged meeting, Shivaji killed Afzal Khan. Simultaneously, handpicked troops that Shivaji had previously positioned swooped down on the unsuspecting Bijapur army, routing them completely. This victory instantly transformed Shivaji into a formidable warlord.
3. Alarm at Shivaji's rising strength prompted the Mughal emperor Aurangzeb to order his viceroy of the south to march against Shivaji. Shivaji retaliated with a daring midnight raid directly into the viceroy's encampment, resulting in the viceroy losing fingers and his son being killed, which forced the viceroy to withdraw his forces. To further provoke the Mughals, Shivaji then sacked the rich coastal town of Surat. These challenges could not be ignored by Aurangzeb, who then dispatched his most prominent general, Mirza Raja Jai Singh, with an enormous army of about 100,000 men. This overwhelming force compelled Shivaji to seek peace, agreeing to become a Mughal vassal and to attend Aurangzeb's court in Agra with his son.
4. While under house arrest in Agra and facing the threat of execution, Shivaji remained undaunted. He feigned illness and, as a form of religious penance, began to send out large baskets filled with sweets to be distributed among the poor. On August 17, 1666, Shivaji and his son used this ruse to their advantage; they hid themselves inside these enormous baskets and were carried past their guards, thus successfully escaping. This escape was a highly dramatic episode in his life and is considered to have significantly changed the course of Indian history.

Section D - Short Note Questions

1. Shivaji, from a noble lineage, was born around 1630 when India was under Muslim rule by Mughals in the north and sultans of Bijapur and Golconda in the south. Witnessing the Muslim oppression and religious persecution of Hindus in the Deccan region, where his ancestral estates were, Shivaji developed a strong conviction by age 16

that he was divinely appointed to secure Hindu freedom. This profound motivation led him to gather followers and, starting around 1655, to begin seizing weaker Bijapur outposts. During this period, he also eliminated some influential co-religionists who had sided with the sultans. His daring, military prowess, and sternness against oppressors earned him widespread admiration.

2. Shivaji is historically recognized as the 'father of Indian navy.' This title is attributed to him because he was the first Indian ruler of his era to strategically utilize his sea power. He developed and employed his naval forces not only for commercial trade activities but also crucially for the defense of his territories. This innovative approach to maritime strength distinguished him from his contemporaries and laid an early foundation for naval power in India.

Section E - One Word Answer Questions

1. Mughals
2. Freedom
3. Agra
4. Baskets
5. Father